Kousha Ghodsizad

Systems & Infrastructure Architect

Amsterdam, Netherlands | +31 6 47 15 49 99 | kousha@iraven.io

kousha.dev | linkedin.com/in/kousha-ghodsizad | github.com/koushamad

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Systems & Infrastructure Architect / Platform Engineer with a backend engineering background and production experience across Kubernetes-based infrastructure, CI/CD, automation, observability, reliability, and distributed systems. I focus on building and improving platforms that make delivery safer, operations clearer, and backend systems easier to maintain.

My engineering style is calm, structured, and operationally mature: clarity over ambiguity, automation over repeated manual work, maintainability over short-term fixes, and reviewable architecture over accidental complexity. I contribute best through platform ownership, backend architecture, deployment reliability, technical review, and sustainable engineering practices.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Platform Engineering: Internal platforms, production infrastructure, deployment reliability. Kubernetes-based production systems, Helm-based packaging, ArgoCD/GitOps delivery, private cloud environments, and platform workflows that support engineering teams. Strong focus on reliability, operational clarity, safe rollout patterns, and reducing friction in developer delivery paths.

Backend Systems: Go services, APIs, distributed systems, messaging. Backend services, APIs, workers, CLIs, service boundaries, integration layers, and data flows with particular strength in Go-based systems. Practical experience with messaging and data systems such as Redis, RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Cassandra, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch, and MongoDB.

CI/CD & Automation: Pipelines, operational tooling, infrastructure workflows. GitLab CI, Jenkins, deployment automation, merge-request automation, release guardrails, artifact workflows, and internal developer tooling. Automation mindset: make repeated operational work safer, easier to review, and easier for teams to understand.

Reliability & Observability: Metrics, monitoring, rollout safety, production debugging. Observability and reliability work using metrics, logs, readiness checks, dashboards, production feedback loops, and deployment hardening. Comfortable investigating system behaviour across application, infrastructure, pipeline, and database layers.

Architecture & Technical Leadership: System design, review, standards, operational improvements. Architecture review, service-boundary design, platform decision-making, engineering standards, mentoring, and technical ownership. Career progression from backend engineer to team lead and infrastructure/platform engineer, with increasing responsibility for system design and operational complexity.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Infrastructure Engineer — CI/CD & Platform
Jul 2023 — Present

Adyen — Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Designed and improved production CI/CD and platform tooling around Kubernetes-based delivery workflows, with attention to deployment reliability and operational clarity.
- Worked with Helm, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, GitLab/Jenkins integrations, artifact systems, and internal automation to make delivery paths safer and easier to operate.
- Built and maintained Go-based developer/platform tooling, including CLI and service integrations for controlled plugin execution and workflow automation.
- Improved deployment hardening, observability, and operational feedback loops so teams could understand merge requests, releases, logs, metrics, and post-deployment behaviour more clearly.
- Collaborated across teams on review, architecture, reliability concerns, and practical automation for production infrastructure.

Senior Software Engineer
Jul 2022 — Jul 2023

Studocu — Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Improved backend and platform-facing areas around website performance, crawler accessibility, and production reliability.
- Worked with operations and platform teams to add monitoring across local, staging, and production environments.
- Built CI/CD checks for SEO and performance testing to make release quality more repeatable and easier to validate.
- Investigated bottlenecks across application and database layers and translated findings into practical engineering improvements.

Technologies: Amazon Web Services (AWS) · S3 · SNS · SQS · RDS · DevOps · PHP · Laravel · Go · Big Data · Test Driven Development (TDD) · MySQL · ElasticSearch · Redis

Senior Software Engineer / Backend Team Lead
May 2021 — May 2022

KolayIK — Istanbul, Turkey

- Led backend and platform-oriented work across HR systems, expense management, data import/export, and queue-based services.
- Applied modular architecture, domain boundaries, TDD, messaging, AWS services, and Kubernetes where appropriate to improve maintainability and operational behaviour.
- Built automation for failure reporting and operational feedback, including queue handling and Slack-integrated reporting.
- Supported delivery through technical review, design direction, mentoring, and pragmatic engineering standards.

Senior Software Engineer / Team Lead
May 2020 — Apr 2021

Wingie Enuygun Group — Istanbul, Turkey

- Led hotel-provider integration work and backend services for provider aggregation, search, caching, and data pipelines.
- Designed Go/gRPC services to manage concurrent provider requests and standardise hotel data from external systems.
- Improved reliability through testing practices, Elasticsearch tuning, cache-rate management, and database cluster migration work.
- Guided the team through technical review, testing workshops, and delivery decisions that balanced reliability with business needs.

Technologies: Hexagonal Architecture · Microservices · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Go · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Web Applications · Design Patterns · Big Data · Test Driven Development · MySQL · MongoDB · Symfony

Senior Software Engineer
Jun 2019 — Jun 2020

Insider — Istanbul, Turkey

- Refactored newsletter and email-delivery systems from legacy structures toward clearer service boundaries.
- Worked on Go services, messaging, security remediation, and data migration across high-volume marketing data systems.
- Improved maintainability through architecture review, repository-service patterns, and clearer data-flow design.
- Built supporting services for A/B testing, spam detection, and queue-based processing.

Technologies: RabbitMQ · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Go (Programming Language) · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Design Patterns · Test Driven Development · MySQL · MongoDB · Leadership · Teamwork · Management · Redis

Senior Software Engineer / Head of Development
Aug 2015 — Apr 2019

Bamilo — Tehran, Iran

- Built and led engineering work across seller tooling, warehouse operations, delivery tracking, inventory services, and internal platforms.
- Owned backend architecture, service design, team growth, and technical review for marketplace operations systems.
- Designed data migration pipelines and service improvements for inventory and seller-centre workflows.
- Helped convert operational problems into maintainable systems for logistics, warehouse, seller, and marketplace teams.

Technologies: RabbitMQ · Kubernetes · GraphQL · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Laravel · Go (Programming Language) · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Design Patterns · MySQL · MongoDB · Leadership · Management · Redis · Cassandra · Apache Kafka

Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer
Aug 2012 — Jul 2015

Sepehr Mahan Tech — Tehran, Iran

- Developed suggestion, task-management, meeting-management, form-builder, workflow, social-network, and mobile API systems.
- Focused on backend services, process automation, maintainable application foundations, and practical delivery for private and public-sector clients.
- Built the early backend and product-engineering foundation that later grew into larger platform, architecture, and leadership responsibilities.

Technologies: Linux · PHP · JavaScript · Python (Programming Language) · Node.js · SQL · MySQL · Redis · MongoDB · RabbitMQ · Design Patterns · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Teamwork

SELECTED PROJECTS

ChanceGoal
Product platform and backend architecture

Go API, admin/web clients, iOS, onboarding, notifications, operational tooling

- Worked across backend APIs, admin/web clients, mobile flows, local runtime automation, and service-level tests.
- Implemented backend foundations around authentication, onboarding state, notifications, persistence, and operational tooling.

Zenory.fit
Multi-platform wellness ecosystem

Next.js 15, TypeScript, Supabase, iOS (Swift), Garmin ConnectIQ, browser extension

- Built a multi-platform product spanning a Next.js marketing and web app, iOS app, Garmin ConnectIQ watch app, and a Firefox browser extension backed by Supabase.
- Designed a creator and instructor platform (Zenory Senseis) alongside feature-specific flows for meditation, sleep, music, routines, and goals.

Socc360.com Global football intelligence platform

Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind v4, iOS (Swift), real-time data integration

- Built a web and iOS product consuming a live football data API across 15 routes covering scores, fixtures, leagues, teams, players, match timelines, and editorial news.
- Designed a shared "Cobalt & Amber" design system used consistently across the web app and iOS app, including motion, typography, and colour tokens.

Pepper.com Platform Work Marketplace microservices work · Remote / Berlin

Backend services, GraphQL flows, image service work, near-cache behaviour

- Collaborated with Supernova and microservice teams to develop features, maintain services, and improve backend behaviour.
- Redesigned and developed deal submission, product listing, and product detail flows using GraphQL.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Go, PHP, Python, Shell, APIs, services, workers, CLIs, service boundaries, integration layers

Infrastructure & Platform: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Argo Events, Terraform, AWS, private cloud, OpenStack, Cilium, Vault/Consul, Harbor, Nexus

CI/CD & Automation: GitLab CI, Jenkins, deployment automation, merge-request automation, artifact workflows, release guardrails, operational tooling

Data & Messaging: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS, Cassandra, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch, MongoDB

Observability & Reliability: Prometheus, Grafana, metrics, logging, readiness checks, operational dashboards, rollout safety, production feedback loops

Architecture: System design, reliability engineering, automation strategy, modular architecture, domain boundaries, technical review, engineering standards

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Software Engineering 2011 — 2015

Islamic Azad University

ASc Computer Programming 2008 — 2011

Islamic Azad University